Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:
Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.
You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double
Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major
If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣7

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦7

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠6

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q J 8 3 ♥ 8 7 ♦ A 7 6 ♣ K Q J 4	
♠ 4 2 ♥ K Q 9 4 3 ♦ 10 9 3 ♣ 10 9 8	N W E S	♠ A 9 7 ♥ A 10 6 5 ♦ Q J 8 2 ♣ 7 5
	♠ K 10 6 5 ♥ J 2 ♦ K 5 4 ♣ A 6 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	1♥	Dbl
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
All Pass			

3♠ by North
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH makes a Negative Double rather than responding 1♠ to indicate he has just a 4-card suit.

NORTH has four ♠s so she bids 1♠, showing a minimum opener.

With 11 points SOUTH makes an invitational bid of 3♠ but NORTH declines the invitation by passing.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 6 4 ♥ 7 5 ♦ A K 9 5 ♣ 9 5 3	
♠ 9 7 2 ♥ A 6 3 ♦ 8 6 ♣ A K J 6 4		♠ A 5 ♥ K Q J 8 2 ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ Q 8 2
	♠ K Q 8 3 ♥ 10 9 4 ♦ Q J 10 3 ♣ 10 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♣	1♠	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♦Q

EAST has 13 points and a 5-card ♥ suit so she should not use a Negative Double. Instead she just bids 2♥.

Knowing EAST has five ♥s WEST can support with just three.

EAST bids the ♥ game.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 5
♥ K 10 5 3
♦ A J 6 2
♣ 6 4

♠ A 10 7 6
♥ 8 2
♦ 9 8 7
♣ 9 7 5 2



♠ 8 4 3 2
♥ 7 4
♦ K Q 3
♣ K Q J 10

♠ K 9
♥ A Q J 9 6
♦ 10 5 4
♣ A 8 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
2♣	3♣	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♦7

NORTH has a Limit Raise hand but after WEST's overcall a 3♥ bid by NORTH would be preemptive, not inviting. Instead he makes a Support Cue-bid.

SOUTH has just enough that she can bid 4♥, knowing that if NORTH has a real block-buster he will bid on.

NORTH doesn't have a real block-buster.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 8 6 4 2
♥ 9 8 7
♦ Q 7 5
♣ K 4 2

♠ A Q J 3
♥ J 4
♦ 9 6 4 2
♣ 10 9 6



♠ 10 5
♥ A K Q 6 3
♦ A 10 8
♣ A J 7

♠ K 9 7
♥ 10 5 2
♦ K J 3
♣ Q 8 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	1♠
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♠6

WEST has 9 points and a stopper in ♠s so she responds 1NT.

EAST has 19 points with a balanced hand so he bids 3NT.